



THE DOLLAR TOKEN

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THE DOLLAR GOES DIGITAL.

In a ruined library, an archivist bends over a ledger. A dollar sign rises from the page into a glowing seal. The image gives an old financial habit a new form: a balance recorded in familiar money becomes something that can move through a digital network. Behind the light is still a promise, written in the books of an issuer.

Tether's anniversary account dates the first issuance of its tokens to 6 October 2014. The project was then called Realcoin. Its original tokens used an overlay on Bitcoin, the system later known as the Omni Layer. They were meant to bring a familiar dollar denomination into a network better known for bitcoin's changing market price. The selected moment is this first issuance, before the name Tether appeared in the public rebrand.

On 20 November 2014, Realcoin announced its new Tether name and private beta. The company described tokens backed by traditional currencies and redeemable for those currencies. That was the issuer's proposition: combine blockchain transfers with a unit people already understood. The announcement's statements about backing and audits were company claims, rather than independent proof that every promise had been fulfilled.

This is the useful tension inside a dollar token. A blockchain can record its movement, while the value it aims to represent depends on arrangements beyond that blockchain. Reserves, the issuer and access to redemption still matter; a token's market price can stray from its intended peg. Realcoin's beginnings help explain the stablecoin economy that followed: familiar money represented inside crypto, with a different set of dependencies carried along with it.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 THE REALCOIN CLASP

The brass plate preserves the project's early name. It places the scene's idea before the November 2014 Tether rebrand; the ancient ledger itself is an invented prop.

02 THE DOLLAR ENTRY

The page's \$1 and accounting columns face the archivist. They symbolize a dollar-denominated claim, not a reproduced balance sheet or evidence of reserves.

03 THE RISING SEAL

Light lifts a dollar symbol from paper into a token. It is a visual metaphor for representing an account in digital form, rather than money being created by magic or mining.

04 THE PAPER PLANE

A small folded plane flies through the distant library. It returns from card 007 as an intentional collection connection, not an object documented at Realcoin's launch.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Tether's [anniversary account](#) supplies the October issuance date and Bitcoin-layer origin; its [20 November 2014 announcement](#) records the rebrand and issuer's promises. The library, archivist, ledger and glowing seal are symbolic fiction, not a literal 2014 scene or founder portrait. THE DOLLAR GOES DIGITAL. is HISTROVE's editorial caption.